

9.3 Tourism is a growing industry

This chapter will explain:

- ★ the growth of international tourism
- ★ the benefits and problems caused by tourism
- ★ the strategies and techniques used to sustainably manage tourism
- ★ detailed specific example: tourism in Jamaica.

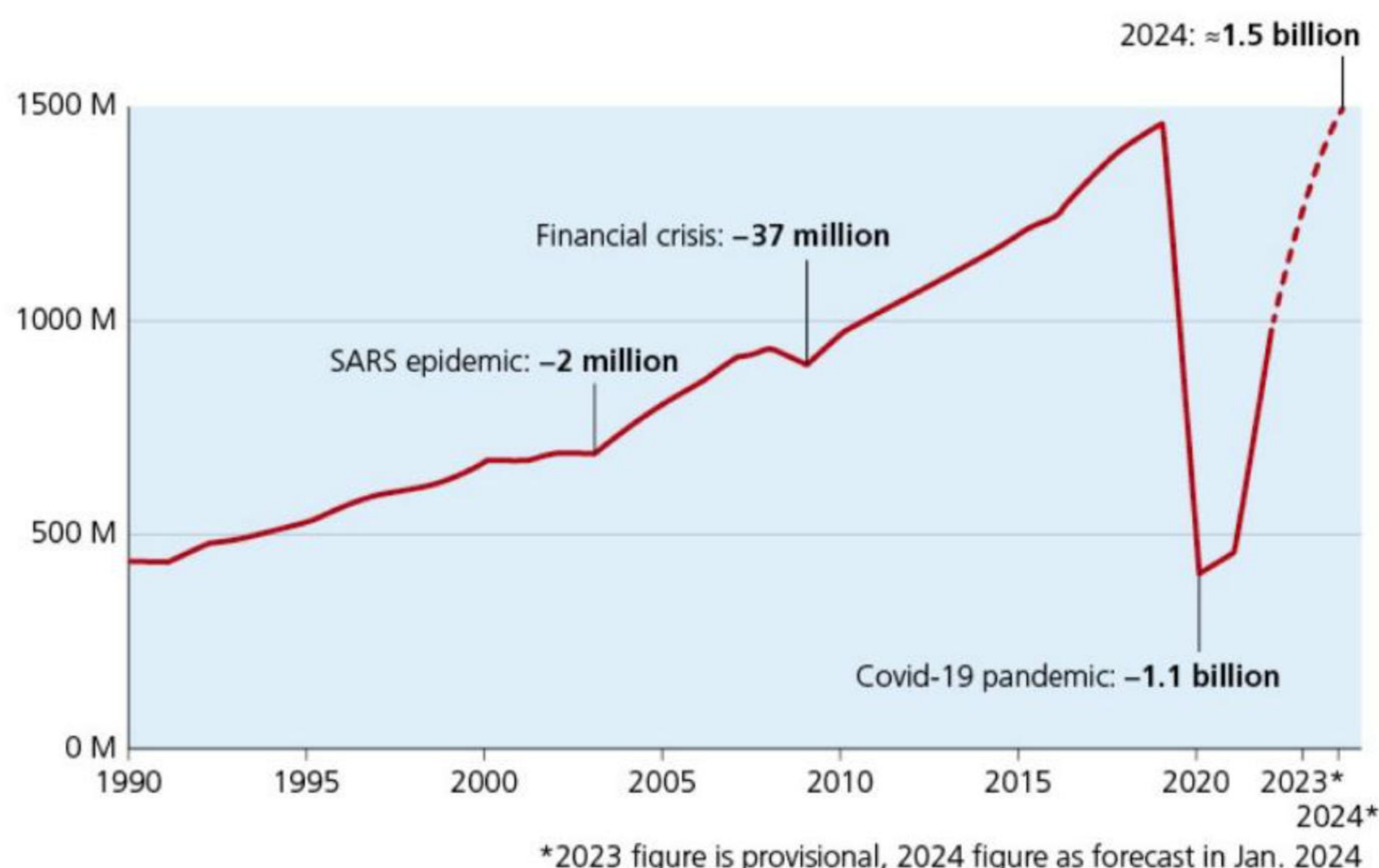
The growth of international tourism

Over the last 50 years, **tourism** has developed into a major global industry that is still expanding rapidly. Tourism is defined as travel away from the home environment, whether for leisure, recreation and holidays, to visit friends and relatives, or for business and professional reasons.

Globally, travel and tourism's direct contribution to GDP was approximately US\$7.7 trillion in 2022, accounting for 7.6 per cent of global GDP. **International tourist arrivals** were forecast to be about 1.5 billion in 2024 ([Figure 9.34](#)), which will be slightly above the pre-pandemic record in 2019. It was only in 2012 that international tourist arrivals exceeded 1 billion for the first time. In 1950, there were only 25 million international tourists.

[Figure 9.34](#) also shows how differently the economic shocks of the SARS epidemic of 2003, the global financial crisis of 2008–09 and the Covid-19 pandemic affected international tourism. 2020 has been described as the worst year in tourism history. **International tourist receipts** in 2020 were only 37 per cent of those of the previous year, followed by 40 per cent in 2021 and 74 per cent in 2022. In 2023 the figure exceeded the pre-pandemic record of 2019.

[Table 9.7](#) shows international tourist arrivals by world region and the percentage share of each world region for 2005 and 2023. Europe remains the world region with the greatest number of both tourist arrivals and tourist receipts. People from HICs still dominate global tourism, but many emerging economies such as China and India have shown very fast growth rates in recent years. When people can afford to travel, they invariably do. **Tourist-generating countries** have a big impact on the flow of money around the world.



▲ **Figure 9.34** The change in international tourist arrivals, 1990–2024

▼ **Table 9.7** International tourist arrivals by world region – percentage share, 2005 and 2023

World region	2005 (%)	2005 (millions)	2023 (%)	2023 (millions)
Europe	56.0	452.7	54.5	709.4

Americas	16.4	133.3	15.4	200.2
Asia and the Pacific	19.0	154.1	18.1	237.2
Middle East	4.2	33.7	6.8	87.0
Africa	4.3	34.8	5.1	66.3

International tourism receipts worldwide amounted to around \$1.48 trillion in 2023. [Table 9.8](#) shows the countries with the highest international tourist receipts. Data is provided for both 2019 and 2022, and figures for the latter year show the tourism industry in some countries had recovered better from the pandemic than others. Seven of the 13 countries are in Europe, although the USA in 2022 had close to twice the international tourist receipts of Spain, the second-ranking country.

In terms of outbound tourism expenditure, the USA and China were virtually neck and neck in 2022, but in 2019 China was way ahead. In 2022, 36 per cent of outbound tourist departures from the USA were to Mexico. Canada and the UK followed in second and third place at 12 per cent and 4 per cent respectively.

▼ **Table 9.8** The countries with the highest international tourist receipts, 2019 and 2022 (figures are in \$billion)

Country	2019	2022
USA	199	175.9
Spain	79.7	92
UK	58.4	73.9
France	63.5	68.6
Italy	49.5	55.9
UAE	38.4	51.9
Turkey	34.3	49.5
Australia	45.5	46.6
Canada	29.8	39.2
Japan	46.1	38.6
Germany	41.8	37.4
Saudi Arabia	16.4	36
Macau	40.1	32.6

Reasons for the growth of global tourism

Tourism is an increasingly important contributor to economic growth and employment in a significant number of countries. A range of factors have been responsible for the growth of global tourism. [Table 9.9](#) subdivides these factors into economic, social and political, and also includes factors that can reduce levels of tourism, at least in the short term. Some of these factors have been active for a longer time period than others.

The medical profession was largely responsible for the growth in people taking holidays away from home. During the seventeenth century, doctors increasingly began to recommend the benefits of mineral waters, and by the end of the eighteenth century there were hundreds of spas in existence in the UK. Bath ([Figure 9.35](#)) and Tunbridge Wells were among the most famous. The second stage in the development of holiday locations was the emergence of the seaside resort. Sea bathing is usually said to have begun at Scarborough, UK, in about 1730.



▲ **Figure 9.35** The historical mineral waters in the spa town of Bath, UK

The annual holiday for the masses, away from work, was a product of the Industrial Revolution, which brought big social and economic changes. However, until the latter part of the nineteenth century only the very rich could afford to take a holiday away from home.

The first **package tours** were arranged by Thomas Cook in 1841. These tours took travellers from Leicester to Loughborough in the UK – a distance of 19 km. At the time, it was the newly laid railway network that provided the transport infrastructure for Cook to expand his tour operations. Of equal importance was the emergence of a significant middle class, who had the time and money to spare for extended recreation.

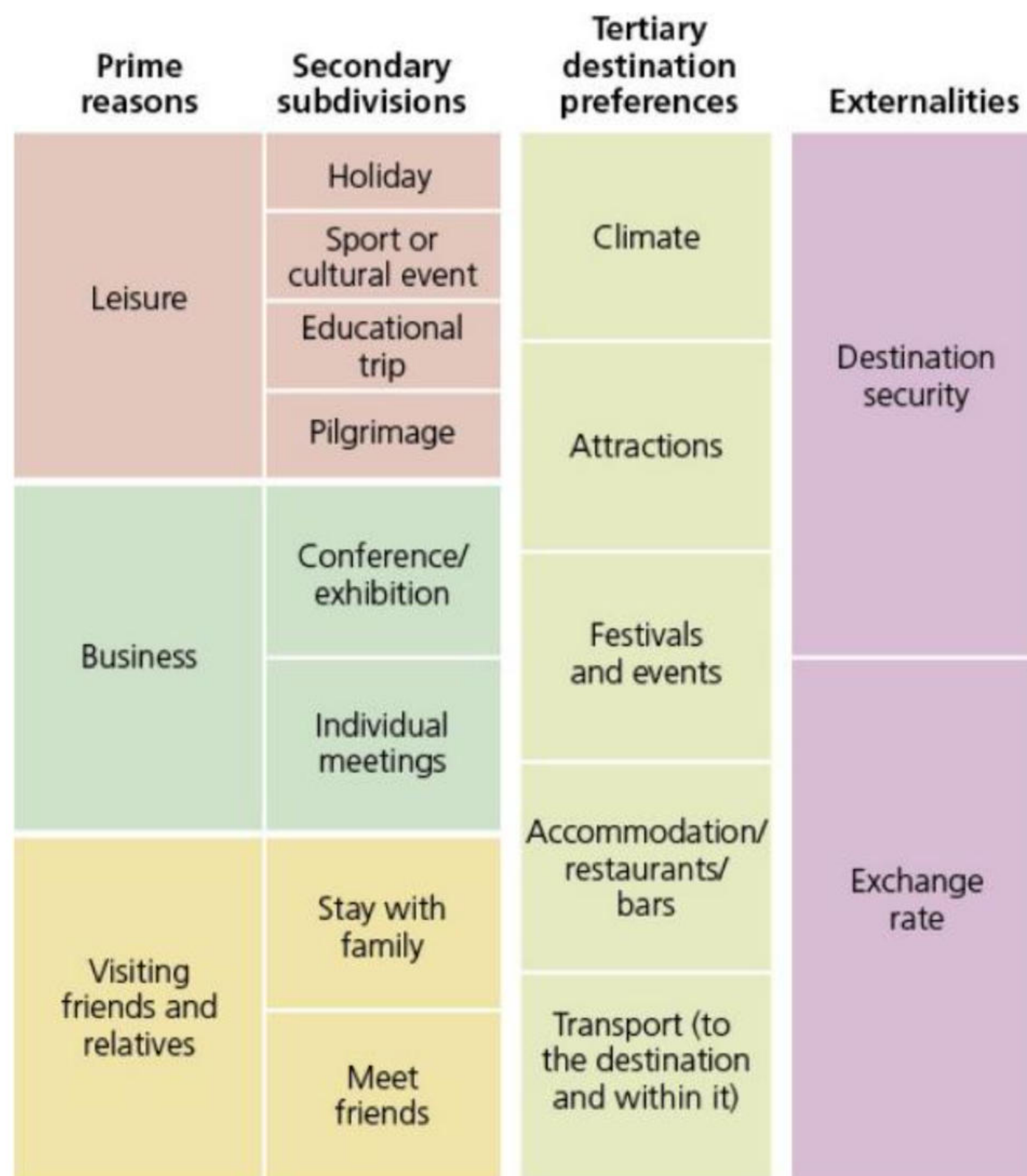
▼ **Table 9.9** Factors affecting global tourism

Economic	● Steadily rising real incomes – tourism grows on average 1.3 times faster than GDP ● The decreasing real costs (with inflation taken into account) of holidays ● The widening array of destinations within the middle-income range ● The heavy marketing of shorter foreign holidays, aimed at those who have the time and disposable income to take an additional break ● The expansion of budget airlines ● 'Air miles' and other retail reward schemes aimed at travel and tourism ● 'Globalisation' has increased business travel considerably ● Periods of economic recession can considerably reduce levels of tourism
Social	● An increase in the average number of days of paid leave ● An increasing desire to experience different cultures and landscapes ● Raised expectations of international travel with increasing media coverage of holidays, travel and nature ● High levels of international migration over the last decade or so mean that more people have relatives and friends living abroad ● More people are avoiding certain destinations for ethical reasons
Political	● Many governments have invested heavily to encourage tourism ● Government backing for major international events such as the Olympic Games and the World Cup ● The perceived greater likelihood of terrorist attacks in certain destinations ● Government restrictions on inbound/outbound tourism ● Calls by non-governmental organisations to boycott countries such as Myanmar

By far the greatest developments have occurred since the end of the Second World War, arising from the substantial growth in leisure time, affluence and mobility enjoyed in HICs. However, it took the jet plane to herald the era of international mass tourism. In 1970, when Pan Am flew the first Boeing 747 from New York to London, scheduled planes carried 307 million passengers. By 2019, according to the International Air Transport Association (IATA), the number had reached 9.4 billion.

Travel motivators are the reasons that people travel. All the major tourism organisations recognise three major categories ([Figure 9.36](#)).

Many LICs and MICs have become more open to foreign direct investment (FDI) in tourism than they were about three decades ago. In general, there are now fewer restrictions on foreign investment in tourism in LICs and MICs than for many other economic activities.



▲ **Figure 9.36** Key travel motivators

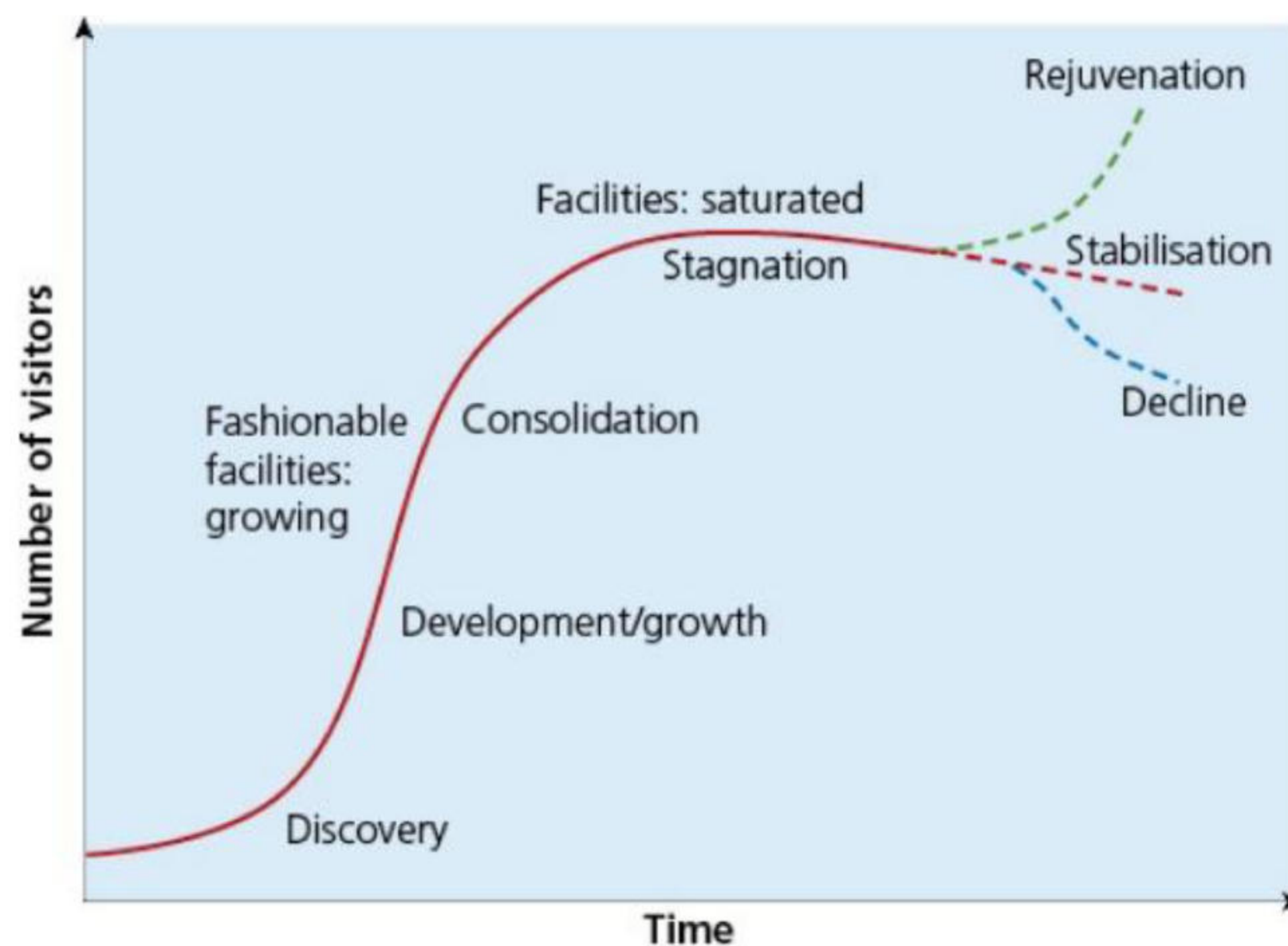
In fact, many governments in LICs and MICs have very actively promoted a range of:

- » 'soft' measures, such as tourism internet sites and support for trade fairs
- » 'hard' measures, such as providing incentives for foreign investors.

Tourism is one of the top five export categories for over 80 per cent of countries and is the main source of foreign exchange for at least a third of countries.

The Butler Model

Butler's model of the evolution of tourist areas ([Figure 9.37](#)) attempts to illustrate how tourism develops and changes over time. In the first stage, the location is explored independently by a small number of visitors. If visitor impressions are good and local people perceive that real benefits are to be gained, then the number of visitors will increase as the local community becomes actively involved in the promotion of tourism. In the development stage, holiday companies from HICs take control of organisation and management, with package holidays becoming the norm. Eventually, growth ceases as the location loses some of its former attraction. At this stage, local people will have become all too aware of the problems created by tourism. Finally decline sets in, but because of the perceived economic importance of the industry, efforts will be made to re-package the location. If these are successful, they may either stabilise the situation or result in renewed growth ('rejuvenation').



▲ **Figure 9.37** Butler's model of the evolution of tourism in a region

The Butler Model has been applied to many resorts on the Mediterranean coast of Spain, as well as in other locations. The coastal town of Sitges is located on the Costa Dorado about 30 km southwest of Barcelona. The surrounding mountains provide a sheltered environment, which has around 300 days of sunshine a year. [Table 9.10](#) correlates the evolution of tourism in Sitges with the Butler Model.

▼ **Table 9.10** The evolution of tourism in Sitges in terms of the Butler Model

Stage of the Butler Model	Characteristics
1 Discovery	Towards the end of the nineteenth century Sitges attracted artists and wealthy people, many escaping the increasing pollution in Barcelona. The arrival of the railway in 1881 increased the town's popularity for the population of Barcelona. In 1916, the first purpose-built hotel, the Hotel Subur, opened.
2 Development/growth	In the 1960s, the advent of jet aircraft and package holidays attracted international tourists in noticeable numbers for the first time. This resulted in the construction of large hotels on the seafront and smaller hotels within the town, along with an increasing number of restaurants, bars and shops catering for tourists.
3 Consolidation	With an increasing number of tourist arrivals, Sitges became a significant tourist resort. It became an even more popular place to live and to buy a second home in. Tourism infrastructure expanded to meet the increase in demand.
4 Stagnation	As more tourist resorts expanded along Spain's coastlines and elsewhere, the increasing competition for custom impacted many smaller resorts such as Sitges. Some holiday companies removed Sitges from their brochures in favour of larger (and newer) resorts elsewhere.
5 Rejuvenation or decline	From the late 1990s, Sitges attempted to rebrand and develop more sustainable strategies. It marketed itself as an all-year destination and invested in a range of environmental improvements. Its relative proximity to Barcelona Airport and the low-cost airlines that use it has made Sitges a popular destination for short breaks and for those who mainly want to visit Barcelona, but want to stay in an attractive coastal location nearby. The Garraf Tunnels built in the 1990s made it possible to drive to Barcelona Airport in 25 minutes and the city centre in 35 minutes.

Strengths and limitations of the Butler Model

The model provides a useful summary of the stages that a number of holiday resorts, particularly in the Mediterranean region, have been through. For example, it has been applied to the Costa del Sol and the Costa Brava in Spain. However, research has shown that it does not apply well to all locations. Prosser (1995) summarised the criticisms of the model:

- » Doubts about there being a single model of tourism development.
- » A lack of detail on when capacity is reached in a tourism destination.
- » A lack of wide empirical support for the concept.
- » The limited practical use of the model.

Also, it does not include the possible role of local and national governments in the destination country or

the impact of, say, a low-cost airline choosing to add a destination to its network.

Activities

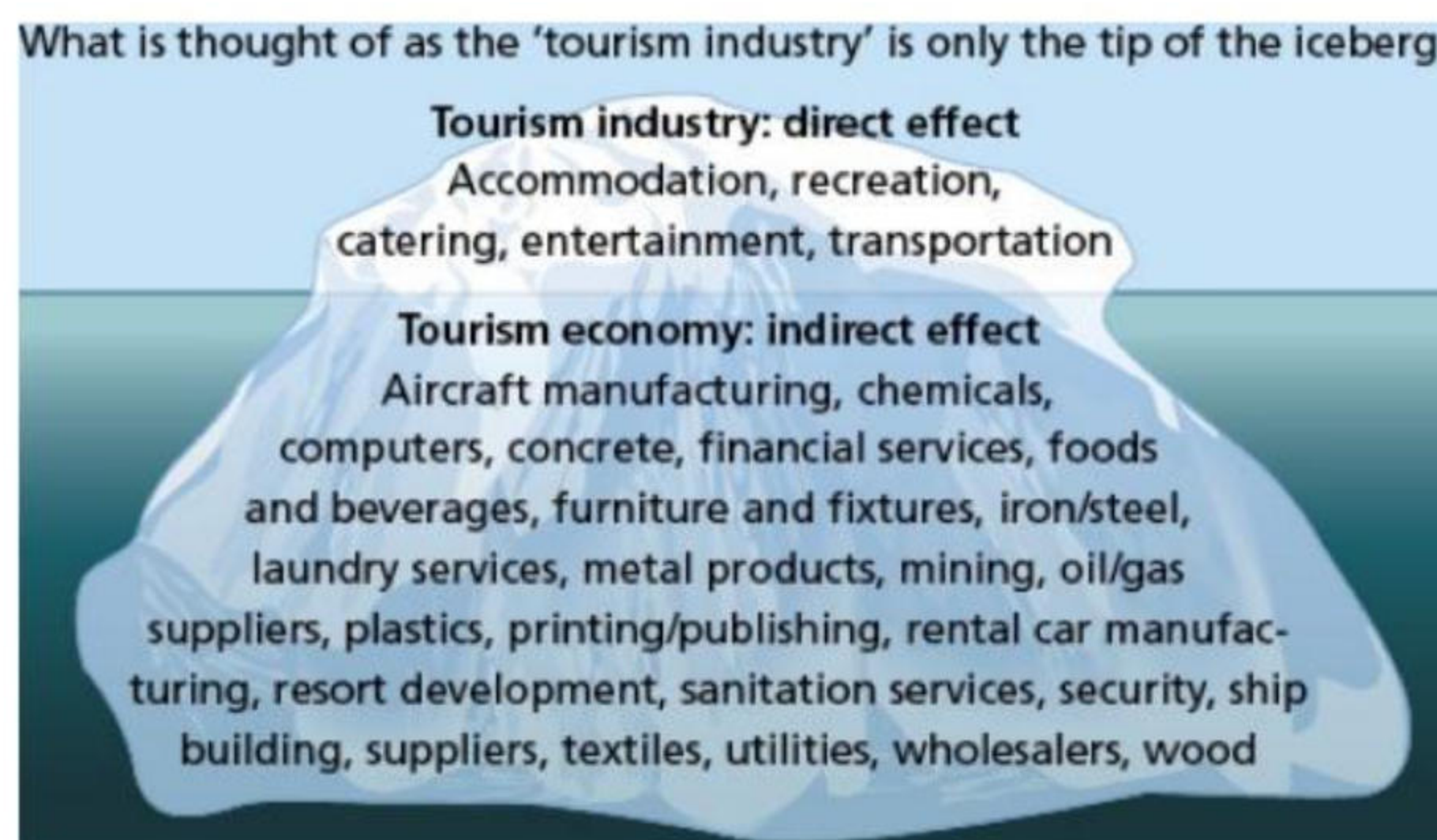
- 1 Define tourism.
 - 2 Study [Figure 9.34 \(page 232\)](#). Describe the change in the number of international tourist arrivals between 1990 and 2024.
 - 3 What were the factors responsible for the early development of tourism?
 - 4 Why is an understanding of travel motivators important to travel and tourism companies?
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The benefits and problems caused by tourism

Economic impact

It is easy to underestimate the economic impact of tourism. What is commonly thought of as the tourism industry is only the tip of the iceberg. [Figure 9.38](#) shows both the direct and indirect economic impacts of tourism. Tourism undoubtedly brings valuable foreign currency to LICs and MICs, as well as a range of other obvious benefits, but critics argue that its value is often overrated. This is due to the following:

- » **Economic leakages** ([Figure 9.39](#)) from LICs and MICs to HICs run at a rate of between 60 and 75 per cent. With cheap package holidays, by far the greater part of the money paid by tourists stays in the country where the holiday was purchased.
- » Tourism is labour-intensive. It provides a range of jobs, especially for women and young people. However, most local jobs created are menial, low paid and seasonal. Overseas labour may be brought in to fill middle and senior management positions.
- » Money borrowed to invest in the necessary infrastructure for tourism increases the national debt of countries.
- » At some destinations tourists spend most of their money in their hotels or resorts, with minimum benefit to the wider community. This is particularly the case with all-inclusive holidays.
- » Tourism might not be the best use for local resources. These could create a larger multiplier effect in the future if used by a different economic sector. A multiplier effect is when jobs and money multiply as a result of tourism development.
- » Locations can become overly dependent on tourism, and therefore be badly affected if there is a downturn in the industry.
- » International trade agreements, such as the General Agreement on Trade in Services (GATS), are a major impetus to globalisation and allow the global hotel giants to set up in most countries. Even if governments favour local investors, there is little they can do.



▲ **Figure 9.38** The direct and indirect economic impacts of the tourism industry



▲ **Figure 9.39** Economic leakages from LICs and MICs to HICs

However, supporters of the development potential of tourism make the following arguments:

- » Tourism benefits other sectors of the economy, providing jobs and income through the supply chain; this is a multiplier effect.
- » It is an important factor in the balance of payments of many nations.
- » It provides governments with considerable tax revenues.
- » By providing employment in rural areas, it can help to reduce rural-to-urban migration.
- » A major tourism development can act as a growth pole, stimulating the economy of the larger region.
- » It can create openings for small businesses, in which start-up costs and barriers to entry are generally low.
- » It can support many jobs in the informal sector, where money goes directly to local people ([Figure 9.40](#)).



▲ **Figure 9.40** A beach artist in Agadir, Morocco – an example of informal-sector employment

Seasonality

Destinations with high fluctuations in **seasonality** frequently face challenges in both peak seasons and in 'shoulder' and low seasons. In the former, issues include overcrowding, high prices and inadequate infrastructure. In the latter, unemployment, underemployment and a lack of services are generally the main issues. Seasonality is a widespread phenomenon, with significant social and economic impacts. Definitions of the shoulder season can vary, but typically it means the period of time between a location's peak season and the low or off-season. For most locations this would be all or part of spring and autumn.

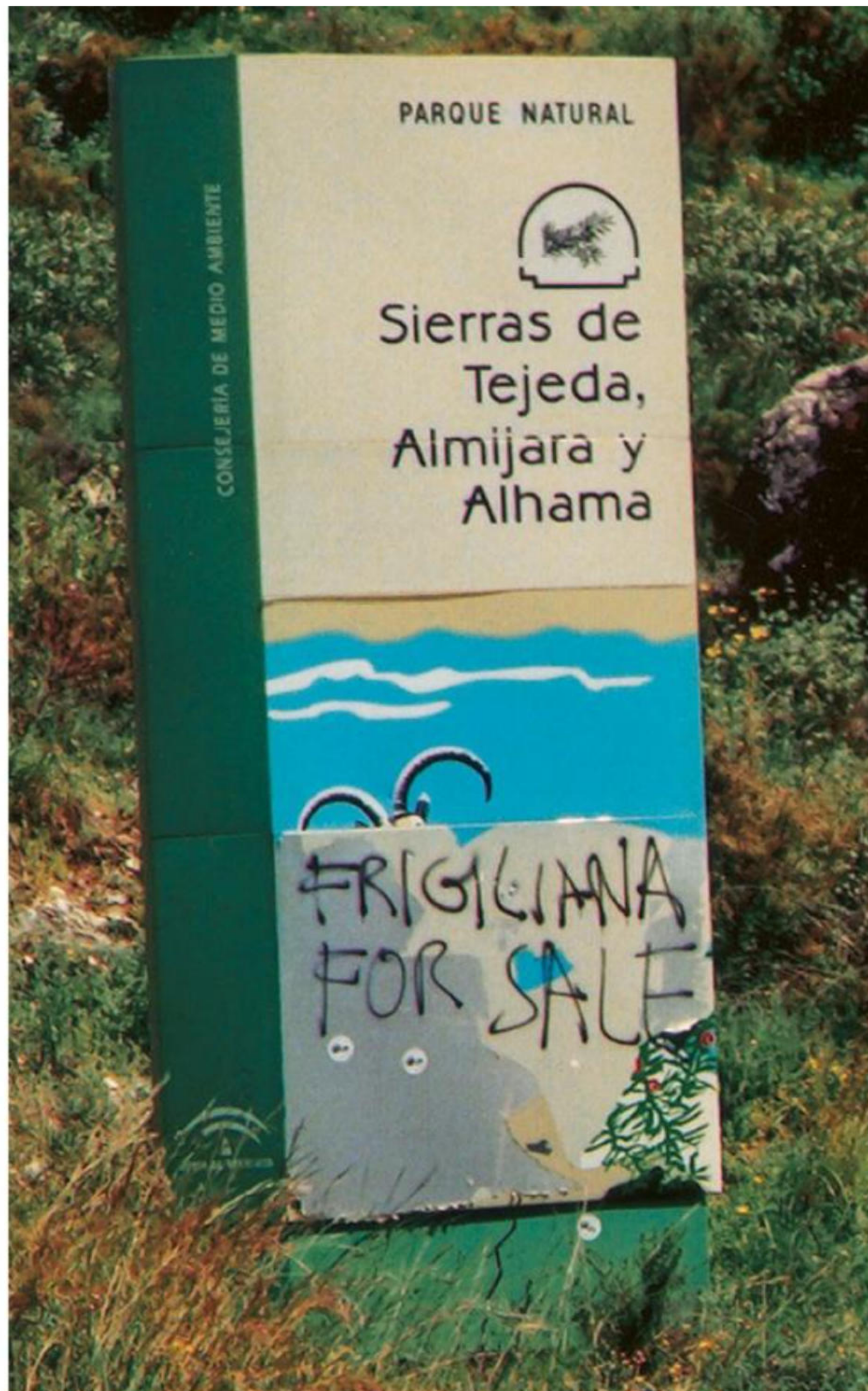
Social and cultural impact

The traditional cultures of many communities in LICs and MICs have suffered because of the development of tourism. [Table 9.11](#) summarises some of the possible social and cultural advantages and disadvantages of tourism. The disadvantages listed in [Table 9.11](#) are mainly caused by foreign (predominantly Western) tourist demands and behaviour. The tourist industry and the various scales of government in host countries have become increasingly aware of these problems and are now using a range of management techniques in an attempt to mitigate such effects. Education is the most important element, so that visitors are made aware of the most sensitive aspects of the **host culture**.

▼ **Table 9.11** The social and cultural advantages and disadvantages of tourism

Advantages	Disadvantages
● An increase in the range of social facilities for local people ● A greater understanding between people of different cultures ● Wider understanding and appreciation of the historical legacy of destination countries ● The development of foreign language skills in destination communities ● May encourage migration to major tourism-generating countries ● Major international events such as the Olympic Games can promote a country's national and global image, however some major global events have led to big financial losses	● The loss of locally owned land ● The abandonment of traditional values ● The displacement of people in the construction of tourist infrastructure ● The weakening of some traditional community structures ● Human rights abuses ● The increasing availability of alcohol and drugs ● Crime, sometimes involving children ● Visitor congestion at key locations ● Denying local people access to beaches and other sites of interest ● The loss of housing for local people as more visitors buy second homes

Attitudes to tourism can change over time. The industry is usually seen as very beneficial initially, but can eventually become the source of considerable irritation. In countries at all income levels, the loss of housing for local people as more visitors buy second homes in popular tourist areas has become a major issue ([Figure 9.41](#)). In recent years there have been mass protests in a number of major tourism destinations about the adverse impacts of over-tourism, including in the Balearic Islands (Spain) in summer 2024.



▲ **Figure 9.41** Entrance to a national park in Andalucia, Spain – the graffiti refers to the number of foreigners buying up houses in the nearby village of Frigiliana

Tourism can also introduce a clash of cultures, with parents in particular often fearful of the impact that ‘outside’ cultures may have on their children. [Table 9.12](#) shows George Doxey’s ‘index of irritation’, which he published in 1975.

▼ **Table 9.12** Doxey’s index of irritation caused by tourism

1 Euphoria	● Enthusiasm for tourist development ● Mutual feeling of satisfaction ● Opportunities for local participation ● Flows of money and interesting contacts
2 Apathy	● Industry expands ● Tourists taken for granted ● More interest in profit-making ● Personal contact becomes more formal
3 Irritation	● Industry nearing saturation point ● Expansion of facilities required ● Encroachment into local way of life
4 Antagonism	

	● Irritations become more overt ● Environment has changed irreversibly ● The resource base has changed and the type of tourist has also changed
5 Final level	● The destination will continue to thrive if it is large enough to cope with mass tourism ● The tourist is seen as the harbinger of all that is bad ● Mutual politeness gives way to antagonism

At its very worst, the impact of tourism amounts to gross abuse of human rights. For example, the actions of the military regime in Myanmar ([Figure 9.42](#)) – forcing people from their homes to make way for tourism developments, and using forced labour to construct tourist facilities – have brought condemnation from all over the world.



▲ **Figure 9.42** Tourists visiting a Buddhist shrine in Myanmar in 2018

Changing community structure

Communities that were once socially and economically very close may be weakened considerably due to a major outside influence such as tourism. The traditional hierarchy of authority within the community can be altered as those whose incomes are enhanced by employment in tourism gain higher status in the community. The age and sex structure may change as young people in particular move away to be closer to work in tourist enclaves. Changing values and attitudes can bring conflict to previously settled communities. The close ties of the extended family often diminish as the economy of the area changes and material wealth becomes more important.

Environmental impact

The tourism industry has a huge appetite for basic resources, which often impinge heavily on the needs of local people. A long-term protest against tourism in Goa, India, highlighted how one five-star hotel consumed as much water as five local villages, with the average hotel resident using 28 times more electricity per day than a local person. In such situations, tourist numbers may exceed the **carrying capacity** of a destination by placing too much of a burden on local resources. The concept of carrying capacity has sometimes been taken beyond just the ability of the physical environment to accommodate tourists/visitors without resultant deterioration and degradation. One classification has identified four elements of the concept:

- » Physical: The overall impact on the physical environment, for example footpath erosion ([Figure 9.43](#)).
- » Ecological: The number of tourists who can be accommodated without significant impact on the flora and fauna.
- » Economic: The number of tourists a destination can take without significant adverse economic implications.
- » Perceptual: The attitudes of the local people in terms of how they view increasing tourist numbers.

Tourism has reached such a large scale and is so extensive in many parts of the world that its impact on the natural environment must be carefully managed. Tourism now accounts for nearly 60 per cent of air travel. By 2030, a 25 per cent increase in CO₂ emissions from tourism is expected compared to 2016. The industry can have a major impact on the depletion of local natural resources, often in places where resources are already scarce. The environmental organisation The World Counts states that an average golf course in a tropical country uses as much water as 60,000 rural villagers. The tourism industry generally overuses water resources as well as generating a high volume of wastewater.



▲ **Figure 9.43** Tackling severe informal footpath erosion on Mount Vesuvius, Italy

Other examples of the negative environmental impact of tourism include the following:

- » The destruction of natural ecosystems. For example, coral reefs are damaged by tourist boats and water sports. In both Belize and Costa Rica, coral reefs have been destroyed to create better conditions for water sports.
- » Disturbance of wildlife and flora, particularly in areas where 'nature tourism' is a major activity. Such activities can significantly increase pressure on endangered species.
- » Congestion and overcrowding at 'honeypot' locations. Intense trampling can cause soil erosion over a considerable area, and waste disposal and littering also affect these environments.
- » The destruction of sand dunes in coastal areas by trampling, intensifying coastal erosion and destroying wildlife habitats ([Figure 9.44](#)). Many coastal wetlands have been drained to provide more land for hotels and other tourism infrastructure. Such actions can cause critical damage to local ecosystems.
- » Air and noise pollution, not just from aircraft but also from tourist road traffic (coaches, buses, cars, motorcycles), and from recreational vehicles such as snowmobiles and jet skis. All can cause annoyance, stress and even hearing loss for both people and wildlife. For example, noise from snowmobiles has been found to cause animals to alter their natural activity patterns.



▲ **Figure 9.44** Sand dune restoration works, County Kerry, Ireland

Education about the environment in the area visited can have a big impact on tourist behaviour. Scuba divers in the Ras Mohamed National Park in the Red Sea, who were made to attend a lecture on the ecology of local reefs, were found to be eight times less likely to bump into coral (the cause of two-thirds of all

damage to the reef), let alone deliberately to pick a piece.

Positive environmental impacts

The environmental impact of tourism is not always negative. Landscaping and sensitive improvements to the built environment have significantly improved the overall quality of some areas. On a larger scale, tourist revenues can fund the designation and management of protected areas such as national parks and national forests.

Activities

- 1 Compare the direct and indirect economic impact of the tourism industry.
 - 2 With reference to [Figure 9.39 \(page 236\)](#), explain the concept of economic leakages.
 - 3 Discuss three economic benefits of tourism.
 - 4 Explain three negative social/cultural aspects of tourism.
 - 5 Comment on Doxey's index of irritation ([Table 9.12, page 238](#)).
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Strategies and techniques to sustainably manage tourism

The type of tourism that does not destroy what it sets out to explore has come to be known as '**sustainable tourism**'. The term comes from the 1987 UN Report on the Environment, which recommended the kind of development that meets the present needs without compromising the prospects of future generations. Following the 1992 Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro, the World Travel and Tourism Council (WTTC) and the Earth Council drew up an environmental checklist for tourist development, which included waste minimisation, reuse and recycling, energy efficiency and water management. The WTTC has since established a more detailed programme called 'Green Globe', which is designed to act as an environmental blueprint for its members.

Sustainable tourism is tourism organised in such a way that its level can be sustained in the future without creating irreparable environmental, social and economic damage to the receiving area. It emphasises the important issues of equity and local control, which are difficult to achieve for a number of reasons:

- » Governments are reluctant to limit the number of tourist arrivals because of the often desperate need for foreign currency.
- » Local businesses cannot compete with foreign multinationals on price and marketing.
- » It is difficult to force developers to consult local people.

Environmental groups are keen to make travellers aware of their **destination footprint**. This is the environmental impact caused by an individual tourist on holiday in a particular destination. The actions they urge people to adopt include:

- » Flying less and staying longer: Replacing business trips with video conferences, and using trains and buses for regional travel if possible. Regional flights emit more carbon per kilometre travelled than long-haul flights. According to the environmental group Transport and Environment, 1 per cent of the global population is responsible for 50 per cent of emissions from flying.
- » Carbon-offsetting their flights: These are voluntary schemes where people pay to make up for the emissions their flights produce. The money collected often funds the planting of new forests that act as carbon sinks.
- » Considering **slow travel**.

Tourists might consider the impact of their activities both for individual holidays but also in the longer term. For example, they may decide that every second holiday will be in their own country (not using air transport). They could also stay in locally run guesthouses and small hotels as opposed to hotels run by international chains. This enables more money to remain in local communities.

As the level of global tourism increases rapidly, it is becoming more and more important for the industry to be responsibly planned, managed and monitored. Tourism operates in a world of finite resources and its impact is becoming of increasing concern to a growing number of people. A travel report published in 2021 concluded, from the available evidence, that less than 20 per cent of people around the world have ever flown and only 5–10 per cent of the world's population flies in any one year. However, this is undoubtedly going to increase over time.

Virtually every aspect of the industry now recognises that tourism must become more sustainable. Examples of best practice include:

- » Costa Rica's emphasis on ecotourism and providing education and training for local people in tourism-related activities – this highlights the potential for tourism to improve broader socioeconomic development
- » New Zealand's collaborative approach to tourism planning involves communities in decision-making – this tries to align tourism development with community aspirations and needs
- » Bhutan's high-value, low-impact model imposes a daily fee on tourists to support healthcare, education and infrastructure development
- » Amsterdam has strict regulations on short-term tourist rentals to protect housing for residents.

Ecotourism is at the leading edge of this movement. Ecotourism is a specialised form of tourism in which people experience relatively untouched natural environments such as coral reefs, tropical forests and

remote mountain areas, and ensure that their presence does no further damage to these environments.

Protected areas

Over the course of the last 130 years or so, more and more of the world's most spectacular and ecologically sensitive areas have been designated for protection at various levels. The world's first National Park was established at Yellowstone in the USA in 1872. Now there are well over 1000 worldwide ([Figure 9.45](#)). Many countries have National Forests, Country Parks, Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty, World Heritage Sites and other designated areas that merit special status and protection. Wilderness areas with the greatest restrictions on access have the highest form of protection.

In many countries and regions there are often differences of opinion when the issue of special protection is raised. For example, jobs in mining, forestry and tourism in some areas may depend on developing presently unspoilt areas. So it is not surprising that values and attitudes can differ considerably when big decisions about the future of environmentally sensitive areas are being made. Often, a clear distinction has to be made between the objective of preservation and that of conservation. **Preservation** is maintaining a location exactly as it is and not allowing development. Conservation is allowing for developments that do not damage the character of a location.



▲ **Figure 9.45** Tarangire National Park, Tanzania – an important protected area

Tourist hubs

The concept of tourist hubs or clusters is a model that has been applied in a number of locations. The idea is to concentrate tourism and its impact in one particular area so that the majority of the region or country feels few of the negative impacts of the industry. Benidorm in Spain and Cancún in Mexico are examples where this model was adopted, but both locations show how difficult it is to confine tourism within preconceived boundaries as the number of visitors increases and people want to travel beyond the tourist enclaves.

Quotas

Quotas seem to be one of the best remedies on offer. The UK Centre for Future Studies has suggested a lottery-based entrance system, an idea endorsed by Tourism Concern. This would mean the number of visitors would not be allowed to exceed a sustainable level. This is an idea we are likely to hear much more about in the future. In 2022, the island of Corsica in France adopted daily quotas to protect the environments of its most popular destinations. The introduction of quotas is much more of an option in more affluent tourism destinations than it is in less affluent destinations as these are heavily reliant on tourism income.

Governance

Leo Hickman, in his book *The Final Call*, claims: 'The net result of a widespread lack of government recognition is that tourism is currently one of the most unregulated industries in the world, largely controlled by a relatively small number of Western corporations such as hotel groups and tour operators. Are they really the best guardians of this evidently important but supremely fragile global industry?' Hickman argues that most countries only have a junior minister responsible for tourism rather than a secretary of state for tourism, which is what the size of the industry in most countries would justify.

There have been many examples in recent years where first public opinion and later local authority action has placed restrictions on tourism. In cities like Barcelona, Amsterdam and Venice, anti-tourist sentiment has built up in response to unyielding tourist growth. Too often, the tourism supply chain stimulates demand with little consideration of the capacity of destinations and the effects on the wellbeing of local

communities.

Activities

- 1 Define sustainable tourism.
- 2 What do you understand by the term 'destination footprint'?
- 3 Which environments in the region in which you live are protected, and why?
- 4 What do you think of the idea of quotas for visitor numbers at certain locations?
- 5 What do you understand by the concept of 'slow travel'?

Detailed specific example

Tourism in Jamaica

Reasons for the growth of tourism in Jamaica

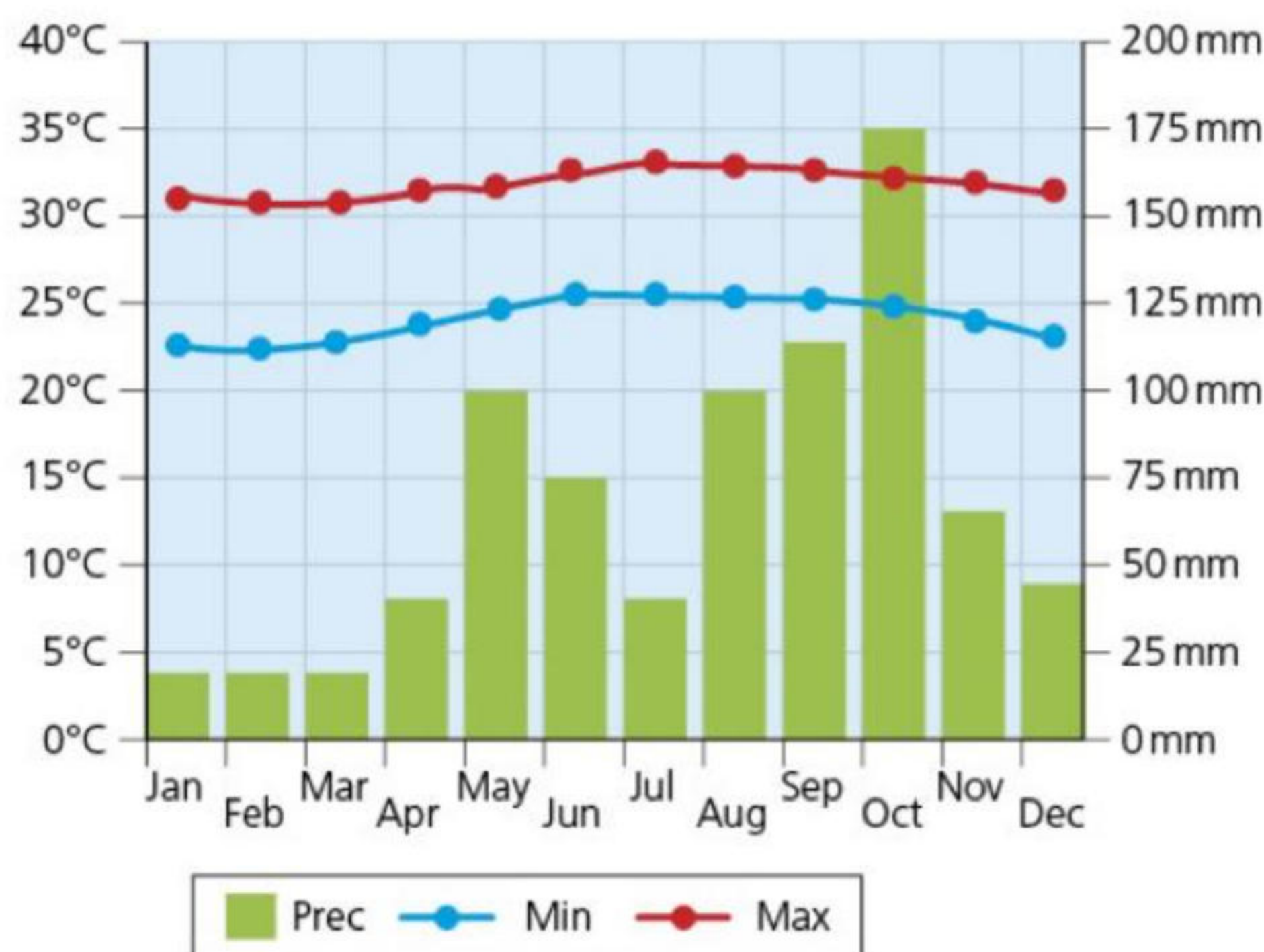
Situated in the Caribbean Sea, Jamaica has an attractive warm tropical climate ([Figure 9.46](#)). It has good beach weather all year round, with daytime temperatures consistently reaching an average of 30°C, while night-time temperatures rarely dip below 20°C. It is the warmest of the Caribbean islands. The peak season is from mid-December to mid-April. This is when Jamaica has its clearest skies and driest weather.

There are numerous highly rated beaches with soft white sands fringing clear waters. Very popular examples are the Seven Mile Beach in Negril and Doctor's Cave Beach in Montego Bay. Jamaica's National and Marine Parks are particular attractions ([Figure 9.47](#)).

Jamaica boasts a wide range of flora and fauna, along with a diverse array of attractive landscapes. Cultural attractions include the fascinating history of the island, its music (the birthplace of reggae) and nightlife, and its food.

The Jamaica Tourist Board (JTB) is responsible for marketing the country abroad. Apart from highlighting the island's physical attractions, the JTB also promotes the positive aspects of Jamaican culture – for example, the Bob Marley Museum in Kingston has become a popular attraction. Such attractions are an important part of Jamaica's objective of reducing seasonality. The physical attractions of Jamaica almost sell themselves, so the government is putting much effort into trying to boost the island's human attractions.

Tourism has become an increasingly vital part of Jamaica's economy in recent decades. It has brought considerable opportunities to its population, although it has not been without its problems. Jamaica has been determined to learn from the mistakes of other countries and ensure that its population will gain real benefits from the growth of tourism. Jamaica's tourism policies have increasingly emphasised the importance of sustainable development.



▲ **Figure 9.46** Climate graph for Kingston, Jamaica

The benefits of tourism

In 2022, Jamaica attracted 3.3 million visitors, with foreign exchange earnings of about US\$3.7 billion. Tourism is the country's largest generator of foreign exchange, and a major contributor to GDP and employment. The tourism industry employs 175,000 people directly and generates indirect employment for another 354,000 people. Most visitors arrive from the USA and the UK.



▲ **Figure 9.47** Jamaica's National and Marine Parks

The revenue from tourism plays a significant part in helping central and local government fund economic and social policies. Special industry taxes have gone directly into social development, healthcare and education, all of which are often referred to as 'soft infrastructure'. However, tourism has also spurred the development of 'hard infrastructure' such as roads, telecommunications and airports. In addition, as attitudes within the industry itself are changing, larger hotels and other aspects of the industry have become more socially conscious. Classic examples are the funding of local social projects.

However, critics of the tourism industry in Jamaica argue that the benefits do not filter down to the general population strongly enough. This is because:

- the all-inclusive resort model, which attracts a significant proportion of tourists to the country, has a limited positive impact on local economies
- the island's location and economic structure mean that many goods have to be imported
- a large proportion of the hotels are owned by multinational chains.

The problems caused by tourism

The high or 'winter' season runs from mid-December to mid-April, and this is when hotel prices are highest. The rainy season extends from May to November. It has been estimated that 25 per cent of hotel workers are laid off during the off-season. This has an adverse impact on the standard of living of households that are reliant on the tourist industry. It also of course means that expensive tourism infrastructure is underused for part of the year.

Although seasonality is seen as the major problem associated with tourism in Jamaica, other negative aspects include:

- the environmental impact of tourism, which includes traffic congestion and pollution at popular locations, and the destruction of the natural environment to make way for tourism infrastructure
- the heavy use of resources, particularly water, by hotels
- the underuse of facilities in the off-season
- the challenges of overfishing, waste management and increased coastal development have impacted on the health of ecosystems such as coral reefs and mangrove forests.

Sustainably managing tourism

Jamaica has established over 200 protected areas on the island. These include the National Park, Marine Parks, Forest Reserves, Special Fishery Conservation Areas and National Heritage Sites. The Jamaica Protected Areas Trust is a public-private initiative that seeks to protect and enhance the country's natural resources and biodiversity.

[Figure 9.47](#) shows the location of Jamaica's National and Marine Parks. The Blue and John Crow Mountains National Park is a UNESCO World Heritage Site. It covers almost 42,000 hectares and includes Jamaica's highest point, Blue Mountain Peak, at 2256 metres. The Jamaican government sees the designation of the parks as a positive environmental impact of tourism. Entry fees to the parks pay for conservation. The desire of tourists to visit these areas and the need to conserve the environment to attract future tourism drives the designation and management process.

The Marine Parks ([Figure 9.48](#)) are attempting to conserve the coral reef environments off the coast of the island. They are at risk due to damage from overfishing, industrial pollution and mass tourism. The Jamaica Conservation and Development Trust is responsible for the management of the National Park, while the National Environmental Planning Agency has overseen the government's sustainable development strategy since 2001.

Ecotourism is a developing sector of the industry, with the greatest attractions for this type of holiday in the Blue Mountains. For example, raft trips on the Rio Grande are increasing in popularity. Tourists are taken downstream in very small groups. The rafts, which rely solely on manpower, leave singly with a significant time gap between them to minimise any disturbance to the peace of the forest. Camp sites are located in areas supervised by the Jamaican Forestry Department. A permit is required to use one of the camp sites.

Considerable efforts are being made to promote **community tourism** so that more money filters down to the local population and small communities. The Sustainable Communities Foundation through Tourism (SCF) programme has been particularly active in central and southwest Jamaica. Community tourism is seen as an important aspect of **pro-poor tourism**. This is tourism that results in increased net benefits for people with low incomes.



▲ **Figure 9.48** A beach fringed with palm trees in Montego Bay Marine Park

As a Caribbean SIDS (small island developing state), Jamaica aims to sustainably manage the ocean area under its jurisdiction, which covers 272,000 km². For island states such as Jamaica, coastal and marine tourism is an important aspect of economic growth and job creation.

Jamaica faces a difficult balancing act: it needs both to grow its economy, but also to protect its environment. In terms of tourism, the two objectives are intertwined. Jamaica has a high level of legislation regarding environmental protection, but critics point to a poor level of enforcement of environmental policies.

Activities

- 1 Explain the importance of tourism to the economy of Jamaica.
- 2 Describe the location and importance of Jamaica's National and Marine Parks.
- 3 Describe an example of ecotourism in Jamaica.
- 4 Define:
 - a Community tourism
 - b Pro-poor tourism.
- 5 Discuss the main problems associated with tourism.

Practice questions

- 1 [Table 9.13](#) shows changes in South Korea's economy between 1970 and 2022.

▼ **Table 9.13** Changes in South Korea's economy, 1970–2022

	Primary industries	Secondary industries	Tertiary industries
1970	50.4 per cent	14.3 per cent	35.3 per cent
2022	5.4 per cent	24.5 per cent	70.1 per cent

- a Define the terms:
 - i Secondary industries [1]
 - ii Tertiary industries. [1]
- b Describe the changes in South Korea's employment structure between 1970 and 2022. [3]
- c Suggest reasons for the change in employment structure in South Korea between 1970 and 2022. [3]
- 2 a Define the term 'globalisation'. [1]
- b Explain how TNCs influence globalisation. [3]
- 3 Assess the impact of globalisation at a local scale. [5]
- 4 Using named examples, evaluate the impacts of TNCs on host countries. [7]